

Research Question

“How can biblical principles and modern psychological counselling approaches be combined to effectively help people who are struggling with emotional or mental distress in a church-setting context?”

Grading Rubric – Research Paper (Total: 100 Points)

Category	Points	What It Assesses	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor
Introduction & Thesis	10	Clarity of topic, definition of mental/emotional distress, church context	Clear, focused introduction; clearly establishes church context and integration focus	Clear introduction with minor gaps	Basic introduction.	Unclear, missing, or poorly developed introduction.
Understanding of Biblical Principles	15	Use, explanation, and application of scripture to emotional/mental distress	Deep understanding: multiple relevant scriptures explained and applied to church setting	Good understanding with some relevant scripture and explanation	Limited or somewhat inaccurate use of scripture	Minimal or incorrect biblical understanding
Application of Counseling Theories	15	Explanation and application of CBT and person-centered therapy	Thorough explanation; clear and practical application to church counselling	Adequate explanation with some application	Basic or unclear explanation; weak application	Lacks understanding of counselling theories
Integration of Faith and Psychology	20	Ability to connect biblical principles with counseling theories in practice	Seamless, balanced, and practical integration; strong church-based examples	Clear attempt at integration with minor gaps	Weak or inconsistent integration	No meaningful integration
Critical Thinking & Analysis	15	Evaluation of strengths, limitations, and ethical issues	Insightful analysis; evaluates strengths, limitations, and ethics clearly	Some analysis with moderate depth	Mostly descriptive; limited analysis	Lacks critical thinking and evaluation

Use of Sources & Research	10	Quality and relevance of academic, theological, and biblical sources	Uses multiple credible sources; well-integrated and properly cited (APA)	Adequate sources with minor citation issues	Limited or weak sources; inconsistent citation	Little to no research support
Conclusion	5	Summary of key	Strong conclusion; clearly summarizes and reinforces integration in church context	Clear conclusion with minor gaps	Weak or repetitive conclusion	Missing or unclear conclusion
Clarity, Organization & Writing Quality	10	Structure, flow, grammar, and readability	Clear, well-organized, error-free writing; logical flow	Mostly clear with minor errors	Some organizational issues or errors	Difficult to follow; many errors

Paper Requirements

- Length: **8–10 pages** (including title & references)
- Format: **APA 7th edition**
- Font: Times New Roman, 12 pt
- Spacing: Double-spaced
- Margins: 1 inch
- Page numbers: Top right
- Include: **Title page & Reference page**

Paper Structure

Introduction (1 page)

- Introduce topic
- State purpose
- Mention faith and counseling integration

Biblical Principles (1.5–2 pages)

- Use relevant scriptures
- Explain meaning and context
- Apply to the topic *Interpret, don't just quote*

Counseling Theories (1.5–2 pages)

- Explain 1–2 theories (e.g., CBT, person-centered), Define key concepts, Apply to the issue

Integration of Faith & Psychology (2 pages)

- Show how both work together, compare similarities/differences, Discuss strengths and tensions

Critical Thinking (1–1.5 pages)

- Analyze strengths, Identify limitations, Address ethical issues

Use of Research (Throughout)

- Use **5–8 scholarly sources**
- Include academic, theological sources, Bible

Conclusion

In-Text Citations

- Paraphrase: (Author, Year)
- Direct quote: (Author, Year, p. #)

Example:

- (Smith, 2020)
- (Smith, 2020, p. 45)

Reference Page

- Title: **References** (centered, bold)
- Alphabetical order
- Hanging indent (0.5 inch)

Examples:**Book:**

Smith, J. A. (2020). Counseling and faith integration. Academic Press.

Journal Article:

Brown, L. T. (2021). Cognitive behavioral therapy and spirituality. *Journal of Psychology*, 15(2), 100–115. <https://doi.org/xxxxx>

Bible (APA 7th):

- In-text

(New International Version, 2011, John 3:16)

Due May 4, 2026